



HOW BENGALURU CAN GET RAIN-READY

Bengaluru's flooding results from a combination of local waterlogging and drainage overflow. The city lacks separate stormwater and sewer networks, causing stormwater to flow into sewer lines during heavy rainfall. Encroachment of drains (like nalas and K-100) and blocked culverts that restrict water flow is a major challenge. BBMP and BWSSB must act to clear these obstructions.

Sediment accumulation has reduced drain slopes, slowing flow and leading to backflow or overflow. Regular desilting is

essential. Many institutions have stormwater drains that discharge into roads or adjacent areas – these outlets must be redirected into municipal drains. During intense rain, BBMP teams should open manhole covers (with appropriate precautions) in flood-prone zones to relieve localised flooding.

Karnataka State Natural Disaster Monitoring Centre (KSNDMC) issues real-time alerts – better coordination with BBMP, BWSSB, and BTP can enhance response. Apartments should install backup pumps to mitigate basement flooding. Lastly, proper lake management is crucial, as lakes help buffer and reduce downstream flooding.

Rajarshi Das Bhowmik | ASSISTANT PROFESSOR, INTERDISCIPLINARY CENTRE FOR WATER RESEARCH (ICWAR), INDIAN INSTITUTE OF SCIENCE (IISc), BENGALURU

The Institution of Agricultural Technologists (IAT), Bengaluru, in partnership with a few NGOs, is organizing a 'Desi Seed Festival' on June 14 and 15 at the IAT campus. The festival aims to celebrate and raise awareness about the significance of preserving indigenous seed varieties, including rice, millets, pulses, tubers, vegetables and leafy greens. Bringing together seed conservators, gardening enthusiasts and consumers from across the country, the festival features discussions, interactive sessions and an exhibition cum sale of indigenous seeds.